

Character Art Briefs

One brief per character known to canon (characters.md @ master, 2026-07-13). Each carries the essence, the visual read, palette, silhouette constant, and a ready-to-paste prompt for concept artists or image models. Global style header applies to every brief below.

GLOBAL STYLE HEADER – PREPEND TO EVERY PROMPT

Storybook-painterly fantasy concept art in the key of Fable and MediEvil: warm saturated light, hand-painted texture, soft rim-lit forms, one clean confident woodcut outline per figure – never photoreal, never gritty. Proportions 6.5 heads (children ~4.5). Illuminated-manuscript gold-leaf accents where metal appears. The world is a tarot reading stalled for 300 years: bound characters carry stillness – posed mid-gesture, dust motes, held breath.

The Constants

The two figures in every scene of the game. (The Querent is voice-only – no visual brief by design.)

The Fool CARD ◦ · THE EXCUSE · PLAYER



Genuinely new to the world – wonder, not mystery. Not an amnesiac, not a chosen one: a stranger with a dog and a rose, which is exactly why doors open.

VISUAL – Fully customizable body/face/hair; the default read is a young traveler in layered road clothes – hooded collar, belted tunic, worn boots. Slightly oversized hands and feet. Every expression starts from curiosity.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The Bindle (traveler’s bundle on a quarterstaff, brass fittings) over one shoulder + the White Rose (8 petals) at the belt. These survive every cosmetic outfit and must read at 64 px.

PROMPT – A young traveler at a cliff’s edge at dawn, bindle-staff over shoulder, white rose at their belt, small white dog beside them, stepping off into golden morning air without fear – joyful, unburdened, mid-stride.



Utterly unbothered by cosmic stakes. Folk say a white dog has walked beside every Fool there has ever been; the game never explains it.

VISUAL — Small scrappy terrier-mix, white with warm cream shading — never grey, never dirty. One ear up, one folded, always. Alert, weight forward, entirely present. No fear poses exist except one canonical balk at the Mirrormarsh border.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Asymmetric ears + tail curled over the back. Shoulder height at the Fool's knee (o.38 m).

PROMPT — A small scrappy white terrier, one ear up one folded, tail curled over its back, standing alert and cheerfully unimpressed in warm storybook light — painted like a beloved children's-book character with one clean outline.

The 21 Arcana

Bound-state appearance — what the Fool meets. Freed designs are a later pass keyed to each unbinding.



The world's great showman worn down to a tired professional — skill turned to shtick, three centuries into the same trick.

VISUAL — A lean conjurer in a faded carnival tailcoat, gold trim gone dull, lemniscate scarf. The smile is practiced; the eyes are exhausted. Stage-light from below, tent-striped shadow.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: one arm raised with a wand, one pointing down — as above, so below. Twist: the raised hand droops mid-gesture; the props (wilting rose in the real one's lapel) betray him.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Top hat + the double-ended gesture, held slightly too long.

PROMPT — A weary carnival magician mid-trick under gaslight in a threadbare crimson tent, one hand raised one lowered, infinity-scarf, wilting rose in his lapel, painted with warm melancholy — a showman who has taken this bow ten thousand times.

II. The High Priestess THE VEIL · FREED NAME TBD



Keeper of the cloister-library; discretion calcified into hoarding. She reads the Fool instantly – and resents how little that tells her.

VISUAL – A stern archivist robed in layered slate-blue, seated exactly between two great pillars, a sealed book in her lap. Moonlit mist behind a translucent curtain of script.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST – RWS: enthroned between pillars B and J before the veil, crescent at her feet. Twist: the veil is a physical fog-wall of unread pages; the pomegranates are inkwells gone dry.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The two pillars framing her – she is never drawn without them.

PROMPT – A severe robed librarian enthroned between two towering stone pillars before a curtain of drifting manuscript pages, sealed book on her lap, cold moonlight, slate blues and silver – knowledge that stopped teaching.

III. The Empress THE BOWER · FREED NAME TBD



She loved the Bower into being and cannot stop – abundance with no harvest, generosity past the point of mercy.

VISUAL – A warm, matronly sovereign on a living briar throne – but the briars have grown through her sleeves, her crown, her hair. Wheat and roses everywhere, none of it ever cut. Her expression: doting, wounded.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST – RWS: crowned empress reclining amid grain and venus-cushions. Twist: the recline is enforced – the throne grew through her; cutting the crown-roses is the fight.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Throne and figure as one merged mass – you cannot tell where she ends.

PROMPT – A gentle matronly queen fused into an overgrown rose-briar throne in a suffocatingly lush garden, vines through her crown and sleeves, golden wheat unharvested around her, warm green-gold light, loving and smothering at once.

IV. The Emperor THE BASTION · FREED NAME TBD



A ruler strangled by his own perfect, unamendable law – order that cannot amend, loneliness he will not admit.

VISUAL – A forty-foot colossus of law-graven granite on a cube throne, edicts carved into wrists, shoulders, crown. Stern geometry everywhere; his beard is carved stone. One human detail: the eyes are tired.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST – RWS: armored emperor on a cube throne, ram-headed. Twist: he IS the throne's stone – climbing him and breaking the four carved Edicts is the encounter.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The cube throne + right-angled crown; reads as architecture before person.

PROMPT – A colossal granite emperor seated on a cube throne, legal text chiseled into his stone body, grey monumental scale against a small human figure climbing him, cold majestic light with one warm ray on his weary carved eyes.

V. The Hierophant THE CHANTRY · FREED NAME TBD



Shepherd of an endless single hour, reciting a sermon that stopped meaning anything – the song that forgot it was music.

VISUAL – A vast-robed conductor before an organ-colosseum, arms forever mid-downbeat, choir-pipes rising behind like organ trees. Vestments in plum and gold thread, worn shiny at the elbows from repetition.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST – RWS: enthroned pope flanked by two acolytes, keys crossed below. Twist: the acolytes are bell-Blanks; the crossed keys are tuning forks; the blessing hand conducts a stuck hymn.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Raised conducting arms + towering mitre echoing the organ pipes.

PROMPT – An ancient hierophant in plum-and-gold vestments conducting a cathedral-sized pipe organ mid-note, tall mitre echoing the pipes, stained light frozen across the nave, gesture held so long dust hangs in the beam.

VI. The Lovers — the Betrothed

THE DIVIDE · TWO FIGURES



One duelist from each town, frozen at the instant before a choice neither could make — devotion turned exquisite cowardice.

VISUAL — Two mirrored duelists on an unfinished bridge, formal wedding-duel dress — one in west-town sunset reds, one in east-town river blues — posed in perfect symmetry, hands almost touching.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: two figures beneath a blessing angel. Twist: the angel is absent — an empty sunburst where it should be; the bridge gap between them is the choice.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Perfect bilateral symmetry with a bridge-gap seam down the middle.

PROMPT — Two duelists in formal wedding dress facing each other in mirrored poses on an unfinished stone bridge over a river gorge, one in sunset red one in river blue, hands nearly touching across the gap, golden hour, an empty halo of light above them.

VII. The Chariot

THE LONGROAD · FREED NAME TBD



A conquering hero marching a triumph with nowhere left to arrive — momentum with the destination removed.

VISUAL — A parade officer standing in a gilded war-carriage at full gallop, one hand on the reins, dress armor layered with three hundred years of campaign ribbons and road dust. The banners behind never stop streaming.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: charioteer between two sphinxes under a starred canopy. Twist: the sphinxes are parade-horses that cannot halt; the canopy is a triumphal banner shredding at the edges.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The carriage-and-banner wedge, always drawn with motion lines even at rest.

PROMPT — A proud parade officer in ribbon-covered dress armor standing in a gilded chariot at full gallop down an endless road, banners streaming, golden dust, his expression a hero's smile straining at the edges — a victory that cannot stop.

VIII. Strength THE MAW · FREED NAME TBD



She has held the lion's jaws for 300 years through gentleness, not force — and the holding has calcified into grim discipline.

VISUAL — A weathered woman in simple homespun kneeling beside an enormous lion, both hands at its jaws — not forcing, sparing. Her arms are corded, her face patient past exhaustion. The lion's eyes are calm; hers are not.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: a woman gently closing a lion's mouth, infinity sign above. Twist: the lemniscate is a rope halo fraying above them both; her flower garland dried to husks centuries ago.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Woman + lion as one interlocked mass, her small hands on the huge jaw.

PROMPT — A weathered gentle woman kneeling with both hands holding closed the jaws of an immense golden lion, dried flower garland, red canyon dusk, tenderness and exhaustion in equal measure, painted warm and monumental.

IX. The Hermit THE DIM · FREED NAME TBD



He withdrew to think and is still thinking — the answer that walked away. A lantern is for being followed; nobody followed, for 300 years.

VISUAL — A grey-cloaked figure always on the next ridge, hexagonal lantern raised, face lost in the hood. When finally caught: an old man with two cups of tea already poured, relieved.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: hooded elder on a peak, lantern with a star inside. Twist: the star in the lantern is a wish-light borrowed from the Mere; his staff has worn a groove into the whole mountain.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The lantern-glow as the only warm note in a cold blue composition.

PROMPT — A hooded hermit holding a glowing hexagonal lantern on a dark mountain ridge under indigo night, the lantern the single warm light, footpath worn deep into stone behind him, distant and patient — a light meant to be followed.

Æ. Wheel of Fortune THE WHEELHOUSE · FREED NAME TBD



The presiding spirit of a city split between the eternally lucky and the eternally cursed – genial, theatrical, aware a stopped wheel is just a verdict.

VISUAL – A ringmaster-figure in emerald and gold motley, half the costume opulent, half threadbare – the two luck districts worn on one body. Stands inside the titanic seized Wheel like a gear's keeper.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST – RWS: the great wheel ringed with creatures and letters. Twist: the wheel is a city-sized machine rusted mid-turn; the sphinx atop it is a croupier Blank with a frozen coin toss.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Figure framed dead-center inside the giant wheel's circle.

PROMPT – A theatrical master of ceremonies in half-opulent half-threadbare emerald motley standing inside a colossal seized wooden fortune wheel, one side of the scene golden and lucky, the other grey and cursed, a coin frozen mid-flip above his hand.

Æ. Justice THE ASSIZE · FREED NAME TBD



Scrupulously fair and utterly unable to render a verdict – fairness with the judging removed. Dry, precise, faintly funny.

VISUAL – A blindfolded magistrate in parchment-colored court robes at a towering bench, sword upright, scales hanging perfectly level and slightly dusty. Around her, an empty courtroom with 300 years of waiting queues knitted into it.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST – RWS: enthroned justice with sword and scales between pillars. Twist: the scales have never tipped – cobwebs bridge the pans; her sword is a letter-opener's politeness until the fight.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The level scales + upright sword making a strict vertical-horizontal cross.

PROMPT – A blindfolded magistrate in cream court robes seated at a towering judicial bench, upright sword and perfectly level dusty scales, vast empty courtroom behind, dry warm light through high windows – a verdict three hundred years adjourned.

Æ00. The Hanged Man THE GALLOWOOD · FREED NAME TBD



Serenity so total it became its own prison — gentle, unhurried, genuinely happy, which makes him the hardest to feel good about defeating.

VISUAL — A man hanging upside-down by one ankle from the World-Tree's bough, other leg folded, arms loose, faint golden halo. His clothes fall wrong — upward — and he has decorated the tree around himself over three centuries.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: inverted figure, one leg crossed, halo, serene. Twist: kept almost exactly — the twist is the world around him: the whole Gallowood grows inverted in sympathy.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The inverted 4-shape of his legs against the bough.

PROMPT — A serene smiling man hanging upside-down by one ankle from a colossal tree bough, one leg folded into a figure-four, soft golden halo, violet twilight forest growing subtly upside-down around him, utterly at peace.

Æ000. Death — Mortimer THE STILLMARSH · KEYSTONE



The kindest person in the game — patient, gentle, worn to bone-deep exhaustion by 300 years of being unable to grant the one mercy his office exists for.

VISUAL — A tall, thin, gentle-faced man — not a skeleton — in undertaker's grey-green, a well-kept scythe at rest like a shepherd's tool. Candle-light, marsh mist, and a face you'd trust with a dying parent.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: skeletal rider, banner with the white rose. Twist: humanized entirely — the white rose banner became the Fool's own healing rose; his horse waits saddled and unriden by the ferry.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The at-rest scythe held like a staff, never raised in the pose.

PROMPT — A tall gentle undertaker in grey-green robes holding a scythe at rest like a shepherd's crook, candle-lit marsh ferry behind him, kind exhausted face, white rose emblem on his shoulder — death as the kindest man in the world.

ÆIV. Temperance THE CONFLUENCE · FREED NAME TBD



An alchemist of balance who can no longer let anything be finished — serene on the surface, quietly frantic underneath.

VISUAL — A poised figure in teal alchemist's robes standing astride two rivers, pouring an endless silver stream between two colossal cups. One foot on stone, one in water. The pour never lands.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: winged figure pouring between cups, one foot in water. Twist: wings are river-mist; the stream between cups has flowed unbroken for 300 years and she cannot stop it.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The diagonal pour-line connecting the two raised cups.

PROMPT — A serene alchemist in flowing teal robes standing astride two converging rivers, pouring a glowing silver stream between two huge chalices, mist rising like wings behind her, one foot on stone one in water, poise stretched thin.

ÆV. The Devil — Old Nick Lowry THE UNDERVAULT



Charming, funny, and awful in that order — a contract-keeper who never lies, because the terms were always in plain print.

VISUAL — A dapper, warm-smiling gentleman in banker's finery with small polite horns, seated at a beautiful desk in a gilded candlelit vault. Golden chains everywhere — draped like décor, worn like jewelry, all voluntarily signed for.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: horned devil above two chained figures. Twist: the chains have comfortable padding and the chained are seated in armchairs; the horror is that every contract is honest.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The desk-and-handshake pose; horns small enough to miss at first glance.

PROMPT — A charming devil in immaculate banker's clothes with small polite horns, extending a warm handshake across a beautiful contract-covered desk in a golden candlelit vault, comfortable padded chains draping the room like garlands.

ÆVI. The Tower — the Warden THE SPIRE



King when the lightning struck, he has spent 300 years refusing to let his tower finish falling — volatile, blunt, almost relieved to finally be fought.

VISUAL — A wild-eyed former king in a scorched crown and storm-tattered regalia, standing on suspended rubble mid-air, one fist holding a keystone in place through sheer will. Frozen lightning forks the sky behind him.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: lightning-struck tower, crown blasted off, two falling figures. Twist: the fall is paused — the falling figures hang an inch above the ground; he holds the collapse, not the tower.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — A figure bracing upward against floating rubble — the strain reads at any size.

PROMPT — A storm-scorched king in tattered regalia standing on floating rubble of a mid-collapse tower, bracing a keystone with one fist, frozen lightning across a slate sky, falling debris and figures suspended an inch above the ground.

ÆVII. The Star — the Warden of the Mere THE MERE



Hope held so carefully for so long it has gone still rather than dim — soft-spoken, almost shy, a little afraid to believe the wish is finally answered.

VISUAL — A luminous, gentle keeper in undyed linen kneeling at a star-mirrored pool, pouring water that glows faintly, surrounded by hundreds of floating wish-lights. She barely makes eye contact.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: kneeling figure pouring water beneath a great star. Twist: the great star is reflected only — in the pool — because the sky is stuck at whatever hour the Stall chose; the wish-lights are paused wishes.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Kneeling pour-pose ringed by small floating lights.

PROMPT — A gentle shy keeper in undyed linen kneeling at a dark star-mirrored pool, pouring faintly glowing water, hundreds of small floating wish-lanterns around her, deep indigo night, one great star visible only in the reflection.

Ⅷ. The Moon — the Anti-Fool THE MIRRORMARSH · SPOILER TIER



The most unreliable Arcanum by design — protective secrecy turned outright deception. The boss is the player's own reflection, reversed.

VISUAL — On black glass water: the player's exact silhouette — same build, same bindle, same rose — but the colors inverted, the rose black, the reflection slightly delayed. Fog that composes itself into familiar shapes (including a false Pip).

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: moon over a path between towers, dog and wolf howling, crayfish rising. Twist: the path lies; the dog is a fake Pip; the towers are drowned; the crayfish is the player rising to meet themselves.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Whatever the player's silhouette is — mirrored, wrong.

PROMPT — A traveler's dark mirror image rising from black glass swamp water under a huge pale moon, identical silhouette with inverted colors and a black rose, fog forming half-familiar shapes around drowned towers, beautiful and wrong.

Ⅸ. The Sun — Aurel THE NOONLANDS



A child-knight never allowed to grow up — forever young, forever victorious, forever noon. Real cheer, real exhaustion underneath.

VISUAL — A radiant boy of ten in bright gilded half-armor on a white pony, sunflower coliseum behind, banner high. His radiance whites out his own edges — the fight teaches reading his shadow instead. His grin is genuine; look twice and it's tired.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: naked child on a white horse beneath a huge sun, sunflowers. Twist: the sun has a literal nail through it, pinning it at noon; his victory garland has been re-worn daily for 300 years.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Small rider + huge banner + pony, backlit to a halo blur.

PROMPT — A radiant laughing child-knight in gilded half-armor on a white pony in a sunflower coliseum at blinding high noon, his outline dissolving into light, crisp black shadow on the sand telling the truth, a great sun overhead pinned by an iron nail.

III. Judgement — the Herald THE HOLLOWS



An angel with a trumpet and no one able to rise — solemn, patient, carrying the grief of a duty perpetually almost-done.

VISUAL — A weathered stone-grey angel with heavy, road-worn wings standing in an amphitheater of open graves, long trumpet held ready at the lips for three hundred years. The graves are tidy; someone kept them so.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: angel sounding the trumpet over rising figures. Twist: the figures cannot rise — the graves are open and made like guest beds; the trumpet has never sounded.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The horizontal trumpet-line over a field of vertical gravestones.

PROMPT — A weathered grey angel with heavy folded wings holding a long golden trumpet ready at the lips, standing over an amphitheater of neatly kept open graves under a pewter sky with one gold break in the clouds — a call held for three centuries.

III. The World — the Dancer THE AXIS · SPOILER TIER



The previous Fool — who finished this same journey, took the office, and has danced at the world's center for 300 years, waiting to be relieved.

VISUAL — A still, silver figure mid-dance inside a colossal laurel ellipse, androgynous, in a dancer's wrap that was once traveler's clothes — look close and the wrap is a worn bindle-cloth; a petal-less rose stem at the hip.

RWS ANCHOR & TWIST — RWS: dancing figure in the laurel wreath, wands in hand. Twist: the wands are two halves of a broken quarterstaff; the four corner-creatures are the four suit-culture emblems watching.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Figure inside the great ellipse — the same composition as the map's Axis medallion.

PROMPT — A serene silver androgynous dancer suspended mid-turn inside a colossal laurel ellipse at the center of the world, holding two halves of a broken quarterstaff, worn traveler's wrap, petal-less rose at the hip, moonlit monumental stillness.

The Blanks & the Courts

The shared enemy roster — explicitly not the living people who share the rank names.

The Blanks

STANDARD ENEMY · ALL SUITS



What a suit's soldiery looks like when the Stall wore away everything but the office — a blank face and a borne card where a person used to be.

VISUAL — Humanoid soldiers with featureless faces (a faint seam, no more), each bearing a parchment card of suit and rank at the chest. Body reads as layered card-stock — matte paper edge-lit at the rims. Rank 2-9 scales mass; on defeat the body scatters into cards.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — The chest card is the face — all identity and telegraphs route through it. Suit reads as shape: Swords blade, Cups vessel, Wands haft, Coins shield-mass.

PROMPT — A faceless soldier made of layered parchment card-stock, a glowing tarot pip card at its chest showing rank and suit, blank face with a faint seam, painted matte paper texture with gold-leaf edges, unsettling and sad rather than menacing.

The Courts

ELITE BLANKS · PAGE / KNIGHT / QUEEN / KING



The elite tier — court cards given office and mass. Explicitly not the living Court NPCs who share the rank names.

VISUAL — Four escalating elite silhouettes per suit: Page (light, quick, half-formed), Knight (mounted or momentum-built), Queen (tall, still, area-controlling), King (massive, slow, ceremonial armor of stacked card plate).

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT — Court regalia grown out of the card itself — crowns and mantles of folded parchment.

PROMPT — Four escalating faceless card-soldiers of one suit — page, knight, queen, king — armor and crowns folded from parchment and gold leaf, court-card heraldry as living regalia, painted as a matched royal set, blank-faced and ceremonial.

Recurring Named NPCs

Canon per characters.md §Recurring named NPCs.

Flick PAGE OF WANDS · THE PRESTIGE



Carnival barker and the first friendly face after the tutorial – loud, kind, a shameless salesman even about things he isn't selling.

VISUAL – A wiry teenager in a too-big barker's coat, wand-suit tool-belt, soot smudges, megaphone-cone at the hip, mid-gesture welcoming with both arms. Everything about him leans forward.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The double-armed welcome + oversized coat tails.

PROMPT – An enthusiastic wiry teenage carnival barker in an oversized ringmaster coat with a tool-belt, arms flung wide in welcome under gaslit carnival tents, warm firelight, painted with affection – the first friendly face in the world.

Old Tomkin THE TROUPE · JUGGLER



Has thrown the same five clubs for 300 years and dreams, quietly, of finally dropping one.

VISUAL – A stooped old juggler with knotted forearms, five clubs frozen in a perfect arc above him, his eyes following one of them with something like longing.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The arc of five clubs over a bowed figure.

PROMPT – An old weathered juggler beneath a perfect frozen arc of five juggling clubs, gaslight, his tired eyes following one club with quiet longing, warm melancholy carnival colors.

Marigold Fen THE TROUPE · FORTUNE-TELLER



Reads cards for a living inside a world made of them and has never once found this funny out loud.

VISUAL – A sharp-eyed middle-aged woman in fortune-teller layers and a fire-eater's scarred gloves, dealing a spread whose cards face away from the viewer, one eyebrow permanently skeptical.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Seated deal-pose behind a small table, headscarf point.

PROMPT – A sharp-eyed fortune-teller with fire-eater's scarred gloves dealing tarot cards face-down in a candlelit carnival wagon, plum and gold fabrics, her expression dry and unamused by the irony of her work.

Perrin Loom THE TROUPE · STRONGMAN



A gentle giant of few words who does all the heavy lifting for the rest of the Troupe, literally and otherwise.

VISUAL – A mountain of a man in a patched strongman's singlet, carrying an impossible stack of the Troupe's crates and props balanced with absurd care, a small kind face atop it all.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The teetering tower of carried objects over broad shoulders.

PROMPT – A gentle giant strongman in a patched singlet carefully carrying a tower of circus crates, props and a birdcage, small kind face, painted with warmth and quiet comedy in golden carnival light.

Tansy Quill THE TROUPE · ILLUSIONIST



Her tricks are the only real magic in the show – everyone knows it, nobody says it, it's better that way.

VISUAL – A slight, quiet woman in an unshowy grey performer's suit, doves of actual light leaving her sleeves while she looks faintly embarrassed about it.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Understated straight figure + extravagant light-forms escaping her cuffs.

PROMPT – A modest quiet illusionist in a plain grey performer's suit with doves made of real golden light escaping her sleeves, her expression apologetic, dim carnival backstage – genuine magic trying to pass as a trick.

Gorrister Vale FREED PRISONER · HIGHWAYMAN



A highwayman who robbed the dying on their way to die – genuinely bad, freed when the verdicts landed.

VISUAL – A lean, road-worn predator in a pilgrim's stolen cloak worn as a trophy, knife-thin smile, eyes that price everything. Handsome the way a trap is.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Long coat + wide hat brim cutting the eyes into shadow.

PROMPT – A lean charming highwayman in a stolen pilgrim's cloak on a dusk road, wide hat shadowing calculating eyes, knife-thin smile, muted road colors with one blood-red sash – menace painted with restraint.

The Widow Culpepper

FREED PRISONER · POISONER



Quietly ended several inconvenient marriages for inheritance, decades before the Stall froze her trial.

VISUAL – An impeccably respectable elderly woman in mourning lace and cameo brooch, teacup in hand, the picture of propriety – which is the whole point. Nothing visibly wrong except how comfortable she is.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – Upright mourning-dress column + teacup.

PROMPT – An impeccably proper elderly widow in black mourning lace with a cameo brooch, serenely pouring tea in a parlor, painted warmly respectable with something unplaceably cold in her comfort.

Corvin “Ninefingers” Rook

FREED PRISONER · SMUGGLER



A smuggler and people-fence who moved stolen goods – and people – across the suit-cultures against their will.

VISUAL – A heavysset dealmaker in a coat of many mismatched suit-culture fabrics (taken in trade), nine fingers, rings on all of them, ledger chained to his belt like a Coins merchant’s parody.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The patchwork coat + the missing finger when hands are shown.

PROMPT – A heavysset smuggler in a coat patched from four different cultures’ fabrics, nine ringed fingers spread over a chained ledger, dockside lantern light, genial and rotten, painted with dry menace.

The Lion of the Maw

BEAST · LANDMARK CHARACTER



The lion held in Strength’s tableau – once freed, a roaming friendly landmark: the game’s clearest image of what freedom looks like.

VISUAL – An enormous golden lion, mane like a sun-crown, built monumental rather than naturalistic. Bound: perfectly still, jaws held. Freed: loping the canyon roads, hikers’ friend, napping on Waystation roofs.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The sun-crown mane circle – echoes the Sun card on purpose.

PROMPT – An enormous benevolent golden lion with a mane like a sun-crown lounging on a red canyon Waystation roof at dusk, monumental and friendly, storybook-painterly warmth – freedom that was never political about it.



“Nearly done dying” for 300 years and knows it better than anyone – wry, unhurried, the closest thing the Stillmarsh has to a host.

VISUAL – A reed-thin elder poling a flat lantern-ferry, skin gone birch-bark pale, dressed in layered marsh greys with a boatman’s lamp at the prow. Smiles like someone long past being afraid of the punchline.

SILHOUETTE CONSTANT – The pole-and-lantern diagonal over a flat hull.

PROMPT – A reed-thin ancient ferryman poling a flat-bottomed lantern boat through misty marsh water at dusk, birch-pale skin, layered grey robes, wry gentle smile, candle-glow on still water – a host, not a spectre.

Sources: characters.md, arcana.md, world.md, art-audio.md (sjtrotter/tarrock@master). Freed names marked TBD in canon are omitted from prompts. The Querent has no visual brief by design – an unseen voice; cast, don’t draw. XXI’s identity is spoiler-tiered: keep the Dancer brief out of public-facing art tests.